

VIT Founder & Chancellor Dr. G. Viswanathan awarded Doctorate by St. Xavier's University, Kolkata



Kolkata, February 15, 2025: In a momentous occasion at the 6th Convocation Ceremony of St. Xavier's University, Kolkata, Dr. G. Viswanathan, Founder and Chancellor of Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT), was conferred with the prestigious Doctor of Literature (D.Litt., Honoris Causa). The honor was bestowed upon him in recognition of his outstanding contributions to education, leadership, public service, and humanitarian efforts.

The convocation ceremony, held at the Biswa Bangla Convention Centre, New Town, was presided over by Hon'ble Chancellor Rev. Dr. James Arjen Tete, SJ & Vice-Chancellor Rev Dr. John Felix Raj. The event

featured a distinguished gathering of academicians, dignitaries, students, and esteemed guests. The Convocation Address was delivered by Mr. Justice I. P. Mukherji, Chief Justice of the High Court of Meghalaya.

Dr. Viswanathan, an eminent educationist and visionary leader, has played a pivotal role in transforming higher education in India. This recognition marks the first time an Indian university has conferred an honorary doctorate upon him. Previously, he was honored with an honorary doctorate by West Virginia University, USA, in 2009, and more recently by the State University of New

York, Binghamton University, USA, in 2024.

Expressing gratitude for the honor, Dr. Viswanathan thanked St. Xavier's University for conferring the Honoris Causa on him and recollected his long association with Bengal. He emphasized the importance of quality education and research in shaping the future of the nation. He reaffirmed his commitment to fostering academic excellence and societal development. He also emphasized the importance of growth in Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) for an improved economic development.

Prominent dignitaries from VIT, Vice-Presidents Mr. Sankar Viswanathan & Dr. Sekar Viswanathan, Vice-Chancellor – Dr. Kanchana Bhaaskaran, Pro-Vice Chancellor Dr. Partha Sharathi Mallick, Director -Alumni Affairs Dr. Elizabeth Rufus, Fr. Dominic Gomes, Vicar general Archdiocese of Calcutta, Fr. Malay Dcosta, Financial Administrator, Archdiocese of Calcutta, Fr. Jayraj Veluswamy, SJ, Rector St. Xavier's College Calcutta were present during this historic occasion.

A special announcement was made by the Chancellor that from the next year, VIT shall institute the gold medal for the best outgoing student in UG & PG programmes.

Rajalakshmi Engineering College signed MoU with Arizona State University, USA

Arizona State University (ASU), USA a global leader in innovation and higher education, has collaborated with Rajalakshmi Engineering College (REC), Chennai, to redefine global education pathways for Indian students. MoU was signed by Dr. Michael M. Crow, President, ASU, USA and Mr. Abhay Meganathan, Vice-Chairman, Rajalakshmi Institutions. This collaboration facilitates the launch of twinning programs that provide students with seamless international academic exposure and dual-degree pathways enabling the students to experience world-class education, access cutting-edge research facilities and gain a global career advantage. Through the REC-ASU Global Link Pathway Program, students can begin their academic journey at REC and complete their degrees at ASU, USA.

Mr. Abhay Meganathan, Vice-Chairman, Rajalakshmi Institutions said "This partnership with Arizona State University marks a significant milestone for our institution. It provides our students with an

unparalleled opportunity to gain global exposure, learn from top international faculty and graduate with a degree that holds worldwide recognition. This is a game-changer for aspiring students who wish to experience world-class education while beginning their journey at REC."

Speaking on this occasion, ASU President Michael M. Crow said, "With India as our largest source of international students, this partnership with REC will strengthen our mission to expand access to rich academic resources and empower students with the skills needed to excel in a globalized workforce."

